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Justin Higgins

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Engineering leader with 12+ years building consumer products and backend platforms. Director of Engineering at SoundCloud; previously Head of Engineering at Turntable.fm and an engineer on Beats Music's Core API. I connect product strategy with reliable systems, from real-time media and content tooling to large-scale web modernization.

Work Experience

Director of Engineering — **SoundCloud** — **Aug 2023-Present**
Engineering management since 2025 — Los Angeles, CA | Remote

- Lead engineering delivery for creator-facing web experiences, connecting product priorities with platform architecture and execution.
- Architected integration of a modern web application into 17-year-old soundcloud.com, contributing to a ~22% increase in creator subscription conversion across the /upload experience.
- Redesigned the artist track-upload experience and improved performance across high-traffic SoundCloud pages.
- Established international-team practices for code review, architecture decisions, testing, and technical debt; led the 2024 and 2025 engineering internship programs.

Head of Engineering — **Turntable.fm** — **2021-2023**
Consumer product and backend services — Remote

- Led engineering delivery of four consumer web and mobile products, from technical direction through launch.
- Designed backend services for real-time video streaming, audio messaging, and video messaging experiences.
- Built payment and rewards services for influencer campaigns; products included Glow.dev, Sup.audio, Seen.lol, and Hightide.link.

Staff Software Engineer — **Hustle** — **2017-2021**
Web, mobile, API — San Francisco, CA | Remote

- Designed a messaging-targeting system that let customers define audiences using their full history of platform activity.
- Doubled perceived client message-sending speed and migrated the application from Parse SDK to a GraphQL gateway.

Founder — **Selfless** — **2015-2020**
Consumer web and mobile — San Francisco, CA

- Designed, built, and launched a service for sharing physical goods within local communities; handled product development and Bay Area outreach.

Senior Software Engineer — **Apple** — **2012-2015**
Beats Music, Core API — San Francisco, CA | Cupertino, CA

- Built subscription billing infrastructure for Beats Music using a legacy payment gateway.
- Developed an internal content scheduler for the editorial team, supporting consumer music programming workflows.

Education

- **B.A. Physics** University of California, Berkeley **2007-2011**
- **B.A. Astrophysics** University of California, Berkeley **2007-2011**

Technologies and Strengths

- Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Python, Go, Ruby
- Backend / Cloud: GraphQL, AWS, Cloudflare Workers, Hono, Terraform, Redis, Cassandra
- Product / Data: React, Next.js, React Native, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch
- Leadership: Engineering hiring, technical direction, cross-team standards, mentorship

Selected Projects

- **GitPushups.com** - A fitness product connecting daily exercise with developer workflows.
- **Secret project, Winter 2026**
- **24HourHomepage.com** - Independent web art project; Product Hunt's #2 product of the day.
- **Privatize** - Open-source git plugin for transparently encrypting heredocs in a repository.